

Intel Broadwell users will love Ubuntu 15.04



The upcoming Ubuntu 15.04 Vivid Vervet is going to be an important release for users of new Intel Broadwell systems. It is expected to ensure that the hardware performs at its best and realises its true potential. The Ubuntu 15.04 release is still a couple of months away, but it already consists of a newer version of the Linux kernel and other new packages that have been shipped with Ubuntu 14.10, out-of-the-box. Ubuntu 15.04 is still on Mesa 10.3, but by the time of its release it will be on Mesa 10.4, if Mesa 10.5 is not possible.

The new Intel Broadwell systems have several updated Linux configuration benchmarks, which make Intel Linux graphics more mature for the Broadwell hardware. When a comparison test was done between Ubuntu 14.10 stable and the current build of Ubuntu 15.04 to figure out the performance differences, it was proved that beyond the graphics, the latest Linux kernel is quite crucial for the best hardware support too.

The latest kernel also integrates CPU performance improvements, as optimisations have been made to the P-State scaling driver. There will be no GCC 5 in Ubuntu 15.04, which means the next version of Ubuntu will ship with GCC 4.9 as its code compiler. If the latest GCC code is upgraded into the system, there is always a possibility that the processors will perform much better.

with the aim of diverting more and more users towards this program. This is seen as a new attempt from Microsoft CEO Satya Nadella to attract mobile users to the company's products, which will help the company get ahead of Apple and Google.

The new releases are the latest gambits in CEO Satya Nadella's attempt to wrest back the initiative in the battle for mobile users, in which Microsoft has fallen behind Apple and Google. Nadella has adopted a different approach ever since he has taken over the position of the company's CEO. He is credited with having broken the company's tradition of exclusivity by releasing Microsoft Office on Apple's iPad, even before it was available for Microsoft's Windows devices.

With this, Microsoft is attempting to create a wider user base for its Office suite, with the aim to further tempt users to subscribe to Office 365, which costs US\$ 7 a month for personal users. The company offered test versions of Office Apps for Android for three months and released the final product last week. Microsoft Office for Android is available for download on the Google Play store.

Google launches open source cloud benchmarking tool called PerfKit

Google has launched an open source cloud benchmarking tool called PerfKit.



Google has described the tool as an "...effort to define a canonical set of benchmarks to measure and compare cloud offerings."

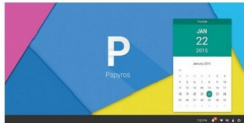
Currently, the PerfKit tool supports Google's own Compute Engine, Amazon's AWS and Microsoft's Azure clouds. Google has worked on the PerfKit project with a team of more than 30 researchers, various companies and customers. The team included people from ARM, Canonical, Cisco, Intel, Microsoft, Rackspace and Red Hat.

There are some companies like CloudHarmony that offer cloud performance reports, though Google has pointed out that cloud performance evaluation is not an easy task. PerfKit can run around 20 benchmark tests regarding CPU performance, database and network benchmarks.

Google says that the tool can also test end-to-end time, and it will provision new resources in the cloud. There is also a visualisation tool, called PerfKit Explorer, which can compare the results. The industry believes that the launch of this open source benchmarking tool is a great move by Google.

Papyrus, a new Linux distro that uses Google's Material Design

A new Linux distribution, called Papyrus, is in the making. It uses Material Design from Google, which was recently used in Android 5.0 Lollipop. Developers have



made some impressive progress so far, though nothing has been released for testing yet.

It's very likely that Papyrus will become one of the most interesting distros available. A while ago, news was doing the rounds that those working on a